Smart Automation & Workflow AI Internship

Week-1 Deliverable

PROCESS MAPPING & AUTOMATION OPPORTUNITY IDENTIFICATION REPORT

Team-19

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- Additional Attachment: “Team Charter”

1. Introduction

The Week 1 **"Process Mapping & Automation Opportunity Identification Report"** activity focuses on building a strong foundation in smart automation and workflow AI by developing a process-first, logic-driven mindset. Smart automation is transforming modern organizations by improving efficiency, reducing manual effort, enhancing consistency, and enabling scalable systems that support sustainable growth. Meaningful automation, however, does not begin with tools or technology, but with a clear understanding of how real-world processes function in their existing form.

Understanding processes before automation is essential because inefficient workflows, when automated, only magnify errors and structural weaknesses. Process-first thinking treats workflows as interconnected systems rather than isolated tasks, enabling the clear identification of inefficiencies, delays, redundancies, and breakdown points. This approach reinforces a **"thinking before building"** mindset, where logical clarity, structured flow, and system understanding take priority over automation design and technical implementation.

In this context, the **Sales & Lead Generation Workflow** is chosen as the topic of this research. Sales and lead generation constitute a real-world, multi-step business system that includes human actions, system interactions, and decision-making flows. The process includes repetitive operations, manual handoffs, rule-based choices, and operational bottlenecks, making it ideal for process mapping and automation opportunity analysis. Automation in sales and lead generation is particularly important since it has a direct impact on productivity, scalability, responsiveness, customer experience, and business success, making it an ideal workflow for building core automation ideas.

Week-1 Objective

Our aim is:

- To understand the structure and logic of a real-world operational workflow.
- To break down the selected process into clear, sequential steps from initiation to completion.
- To identify actions, actors, and decision points within the workflow.
- To examine delays, inefficiencies, repetitions, and process gaps.
- To recognize tasks and steps that are suitable for automation.
- To develop a systems-thinking mindset that supports effective automation design.

Deliverables

This Week-1 submission includes the following core outputs:

- **Process Map (Before Automation)**
- **Automation Opportunity List**

Together, we as a team will establish a clear analytical foundation for future automation design by presenting the workflow as a structured system, identifying inefficiencies, and highlighting meaningful opportunities where automation can improve efficiency, accuracy, consistency, and scalability.

2. Workflow Selection & Context

The ***Sales & Lead Generation Workflow*** was selected for this study because it is a core operational process used across most modern organizations and has a direct impact on business growth and customer acquisition. The effectiveness of this workflow directly influences response time, revenue generation, and customer experience.

Sales and lead generation processes often develop organically rather than through structured design. As a result, they commonly include manual handoffs, inconsistent decision-making, and reliance on individual effort. These characteristics make the workflow realistic and suitable for detailed process analysis.

The workflow begins with lead acquisition through channels such as websites, advertisements, or referrals and ends with either lead conversion or drop-off. It involves multiple steps, including data capture, screening, qualification, assignment, and follow-up. Throughout the process, there is a combination of human actions, system interactions, and decision points, making it a multi-step, logic-driven workflow.

This workflow is well-suited for automation study because it contains repetitive tasks, rule-based decisions, and time-sensitive actions. Common issues such as manual data entry, delayed follow-ups, inconsistent lead qualification, and poor tracking highlight clear opportunities for process improvement.

From a systems perspective, the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow represents an interconnected process where inputs, decisions, and outcomes are closely linked. Studying this workflow enables the identification of inefficiencies and automation opportunities without focusing on specific tools or technologies.

Overall, this workflow was chosen because it reflects a real-world business system with measurable impact, operational complexity, and strong potential for improvement through structured automation and process optimization.

3. Process Overview (Before Automation)

Purpose: To establish a high-level understanding of the manual logic required to move a potential customer from initial interest to an active sales opportunity.

A. The Transformation System

The workflow operates as a linear system where raw, unstructured data is processed and converted into a qualified lead.

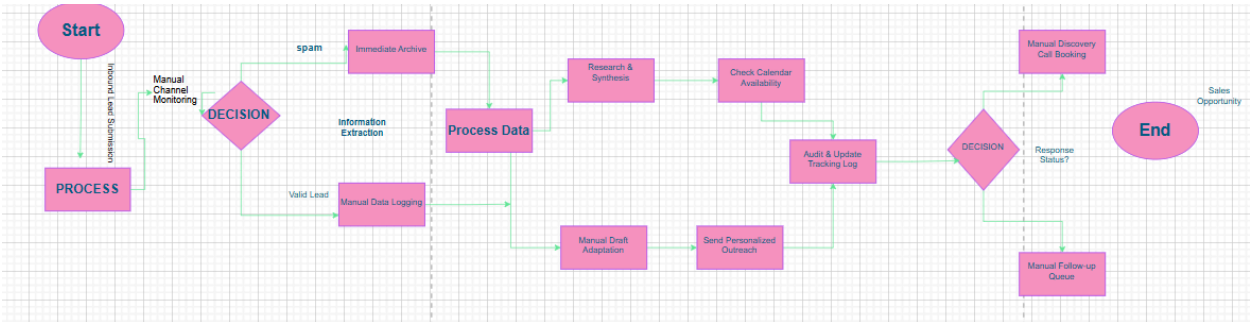
- **Input (The Trigger):** A potential lead submits contact information via a digital touchpoint (website form, social media ad, or direct referral).
- **The Process:** A series of human-led interventions involving data verification, manual logging, context research, and personalized outreach.
- **Output (The Result):** A lead is either successfully scheduled for a discovery call (Qualified) or removed from the active queue due to lack of fit or non-response (Archived/Nurture).

B. Input → Process → Output Logic

PHASE	ACTION
Input	Customer Form Submission (Name, Email, Inquiry)
Process	Lead Identification → Data Transcription → Personalization → Manual Outreach
Output	Confirmed Discovery Call or Lead Archive

C. Manual Logic Flow Diagram

The following diagram illustrates the detailed sequential steps and human-led decision points as described in the operational workflow.



D. Operational Step-by-Step (As-Is State)

This section details the manual labor required to maintain the system.

1. **Continuous Monitoring:** The operator must manually refresh communication channels (Email, CRM dashboards, or Webform logs) to identify new arrivals.
2. **Information Extraction:** The operator reads the inquiry to identify "Signal" vs "Noise" (e.g., distinguishing a high-value prospect from spam).
3. **Manual Data Logging:** Transcription of lead data into a master tracking sheet. This step is prone to human error, such as typos in email addresses or names.
4. **Contextual Synthesis:** The operator must recall or look up specific "Sales Scripts" or "Value Propositions" and manually adapt them to the lead's specific inquiry.
5. **Calendar Coordination:** Without automated booking, the operator must check their own availability and manually propose time slots, often leading to "Email Tag."
6. **Audit & Tracking:** Every outreach attempt must be manually recorded to ensure the lead isn't contacted twice or forgotten.

E. Identified Challenges in the Manual State

- **Response Latency:** Human delays in monitoring can lead to lead "cooling," where the prospect loses interest before the first contact.
- **Inconsistency:** Personalization quality varies based on the operator's current workload and focus.
- **Limited Scalability:** The volume of leads that can be processed is strictly limited by the hours in a human workday.

4. Process Map (Before Automation)

This section presents the **as-is process map** of the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow, where we document how the system currently operates without automation. We focused on mapping the real operational flow as it exists in practice, capturing each step, actor, and decision point to understand how leads move through the system from initial generation to final closure. This

representation allows us to view the workflow as a connected system rather than a set of isolated actions.

Step 1: Lead Generation Trigger

- **Action description:** A potential lead is generated via marketing or outreach activity
- **Actor:** System
- **Flow logic:** Triggered when a prospect interacts with a channel (website form, ad click, referral, event, etc.)

Step 2: Lead Data Capture

- **Action description:** Capture lead details (name, contact info, source, intent)
- **Actor:** System
- **Flow logic:** Data is automatically captured into a lead intake form or landing page

Step 3: Manual Data Entry

- **Action description:** Additional lead details are entered or corrected
- **Actor:** Human
- **Flow logic:** Required if data is incomplete, unstructured, or sourced offline

Step 4: Initial Screening

- **Action description:** Basic validation of lead information
- **Actor:** Human / System
- **Flow logic:** Checks for duplicates, missing fields, or invalid contact details

Step 5: Lead Qualification Decision

- **Action description:** Determine if the lead meets minimum qualification criteria
- **Actor:** Decision Point
- **Flow logic:**If qualified, proceed to categorization
  If not qualified, move to nurturing or drop-off

Step 6: Lead Categorization

- **Action description:** Classify the lead (e.g., hot, warm, cold, priority segment)
- **Actor:** System
- **Flow logic:** Rules-based or score-based classification using predefined criteria

Step 7: Lead Assignment

- **Action description:** Assign the lead to a sales agent or team

- **Actor:** System
- **Flow logic:** Assignment based on geography, product type, workload, or priority

Step 8: Follow-up Action

- **Action description:** Initial outreach to the lead
- **Actor:** Human
- **Flow logic:** Sales agent contacts the lead via call, email, or message

Step 9: Lead Nurturing

- **Action description:** Ongoing engagement and relationship building
- **Actor:** System / Human
- **Flow logic:** Automated campaigns or manual follow-ups until readiness to convert

Step 10: Conversion or Drop-off

- **Action description:** Lead either converts or disengages
- **Actor:** Decision Point
- **Flow logic:**Convert → proceed to CRM update
  Drop-off → mark as lost or recycle for future nurturing

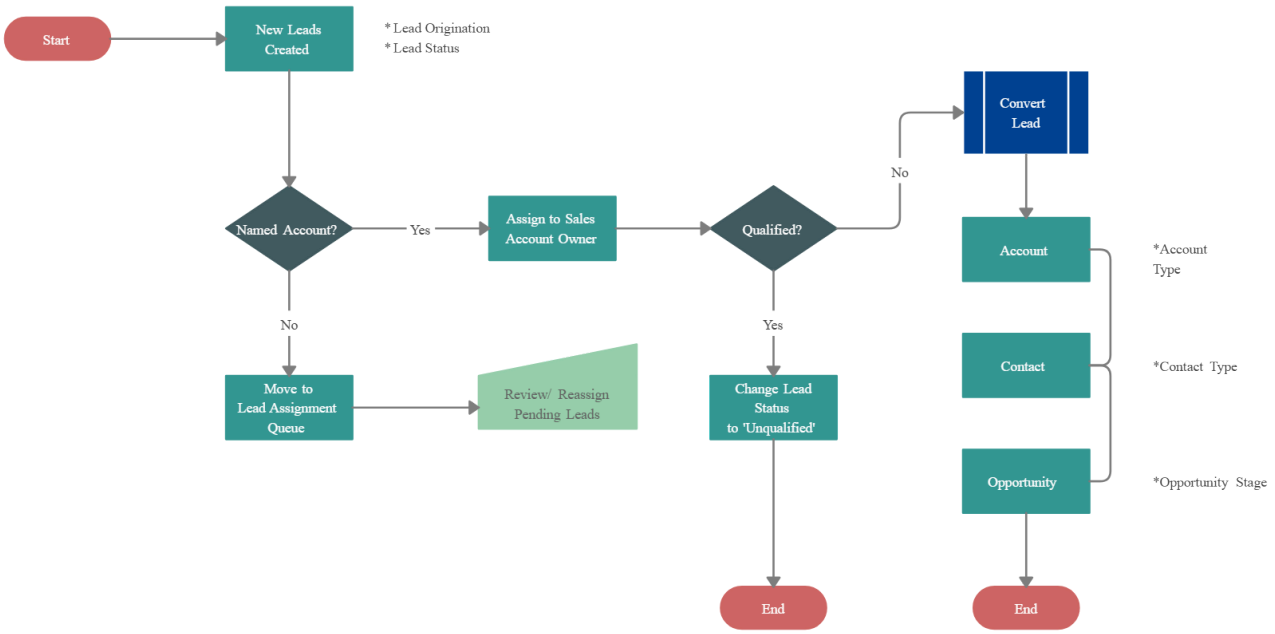
Step 11: CRM Update

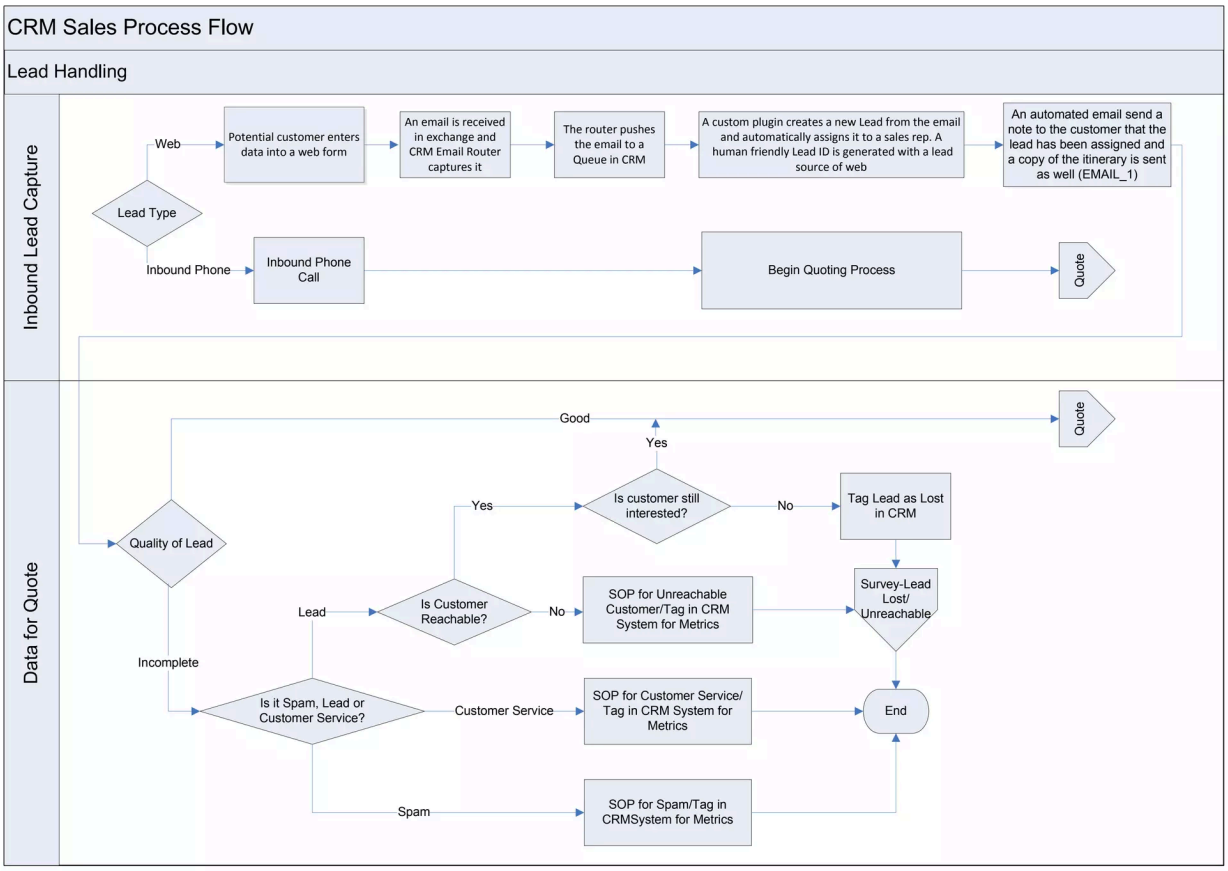
- **Action description:** Update lead status and interaction history
- **Actor:** System
- **Flow logic:** CRM reflects final outcome and stores audit trail

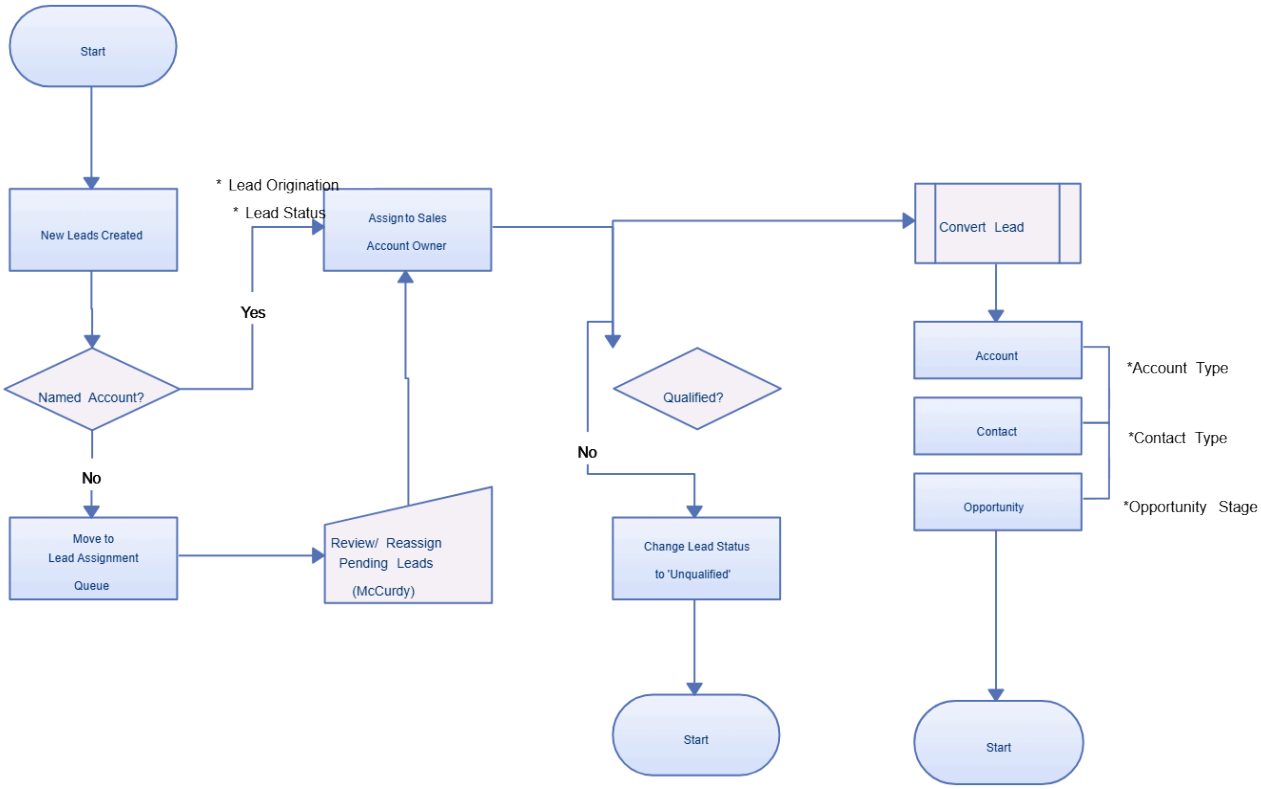
Step 12: Process Closure

- **Action description:** Close the lead lifecycle
- **Actor:** System
- **Flow logic:** Workflow ends with a finalized lead status (converted, lost, dormant)

The structured steps above represent the complete **as-is operational flow** of the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow, capturing the full lifecycle of a lead from initial generation to final process closure. This step-by-step mapping provides a clear logical foundation for visual representation, allowing the workflow structure, decision points, and actor interactions to be illustrated through a process flow diagram for better system-level understanding.


Start
New Leads Created
* Lead Origination
* Lead Status
Named Account?
Yes
Assign to Sales Account Owner
Qualified?
No
Convert Lead
Account
*Account Type
Contact
*Contact Type
Opportunity
*Opportunity Stage
No
Move to Lead Assignment Queue
Review/ Reassign Pending Leads
Yes
Change Lead Status to 'Unqualified'
End
End


CRM Sales Process Flow
Lead Handling
Inbound Lead Capture
Lead Type
Web
Potential customer enters data into a web form
An email is received in exchange and CRM Email Router captures it
The router pushes the email to a Queue in CRM
A custom plugin creates a new Lead from the email and automatically assigns it to a sales rep. A human friendly Lead ID is generated with a lead source of web
An automated email send a note to the customer that the lead has been assigned and a copy of the itinerary is sent as well (EMAIL_1)
Inbound Phone
Inbound Phone Call
Begin Quoting Process
Quote
Data for Quote
Quality of Lead
Good
Quote
Yes
Is customer still interested?
No
Tag Lead as Lost in CRM
Yes
Lead
Is Customer Reachable?
No
SOP for Unreachable Customer/Tag in CRM System for Metrics
Survey-Lead Lost/ Unreachable
Incomplete
Is it Spam, Lead or Customer Service?
Customer Service
SOP for Customer Service/ Tag in CRM System for Metrics
End
Spam
SOP for Spam/Tag in CRMSystem for Metrics



5. Actors & Decision Points Identification

In this section, we identified the **human actors, system components, and logical decision points** involved in the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow. Understanding who performs each action and where decisions occur is essential for viewing the workflow as an interconnected system rather than a sequence of isolated tasks. This structure highlights how information flows, where control shifts between humans and systems, and where logic governs the movement of leads through the process.

Human Actors

- **Sales Representatives:**
  Responsible for lead engagement, communication, follow-ups, qualification discussions, and conversion activities.
- **Sales Managers / Team Leads:**
  Oversee lead distribution, performance monitoring, prioritization rules, and escalation handling.
- **Support/Operations Staff:**
  Assist in data verification, CRM maintenance, reporting, and coordination between systems and teams.

System Actors

- **Lead Capture Systems:**
  Web forms, landing pages, ad platforms, and referral channels that collect lead data.
- **CRM Systems:**
  Central storage for lead records, interaction history, and status tracking.
- **Email & Communication Systems:**
  Used for outreach, follow-ups, confirmations, and nurturing communication.
- **Databases / Spreadsheets:**
  Used for manual tracking, reporting, and audit logs in non-automated states.
- **Scheduling Systems:**
  Manage availability, appointments, and booking coordination.

Key Decision Points

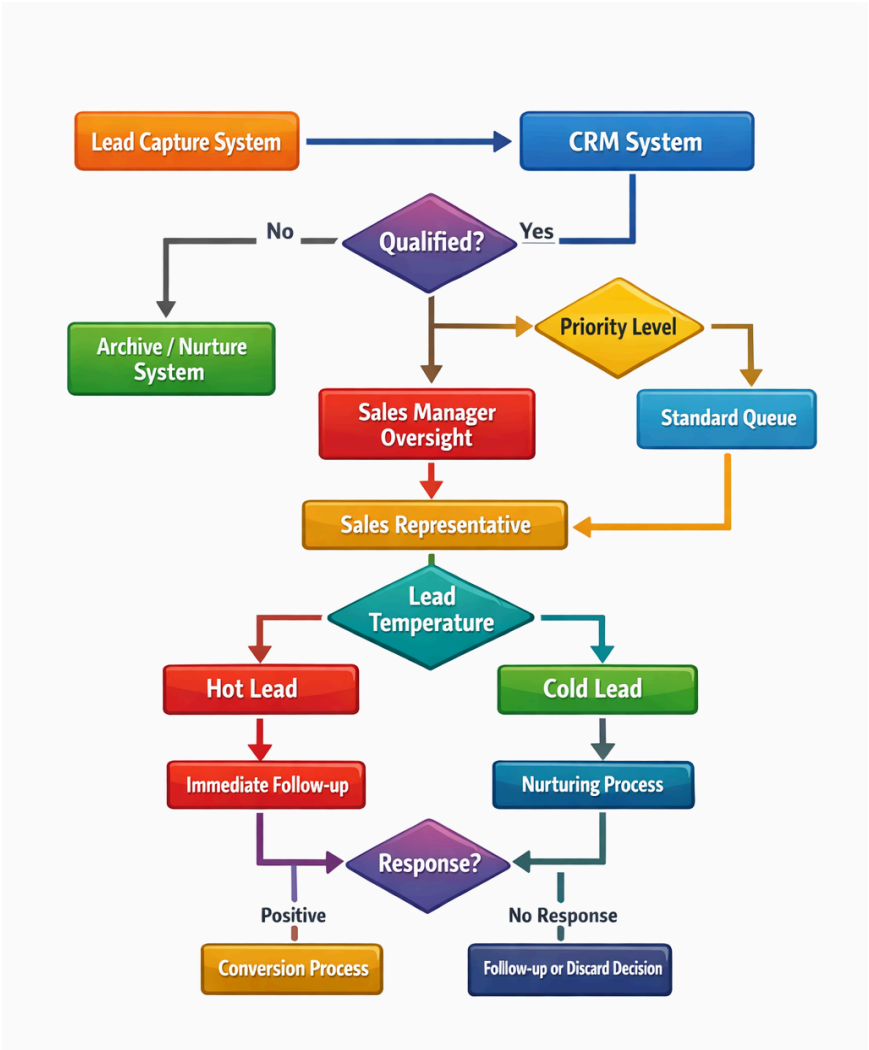
- **Qualified vs Unqualified:**
  Determines whether a lead proceeds in the sales pipeline or is archived/nurtured.
- **High Priority vs Low Priority:**
  Controls urgency, response time, and resource allocation.
- **Hot Lead vs Cold Lead:**
  Defines engagement intensity and follow-up strategy.
- **Follow-up vs Discard:**
  Decides whether a lead remains active in the workflow or exits the process.

These decision points act as **logic gates** within the workflow, directing the flow of leads based on predefined rules, human judgment, or contextual evaluation. They are critical control nodes that determine system behavior and process outcomes.

5.1 System Logic Flow Diagram (Actors & Decisions View)

The following system logic flow diagram presents a high-level visualization of how human actors, system components, and decision points interact within the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow. It illustrates the control logic of the process, showing how leads move through qualification, prioritization, assignment, engagement, and conversion paths based on structured decisions rather than isolated actions.

(Conceptual workflow intelligence diagram)



6. Bottlenecks, Inefficiencies & Process Gaps

After completing the process mapping and actor identification in the earlier sections, we analyzed the Sales & Lead Generation workflow to identify key bottlenecks, inefficiencies, and process gaps in its pre-automation state. This analysis helped us understand where delays, errors, and breakdowns commonly occur and how they affect efficiency, consistency, and scalability across the workflow.

Manual Data Entry Delays

- Lead data often requires manual review and entry after initial capture
- This slows down the early stages of the workflow
- High lead volumes increase backlog and processing delays

Lead Response Delays

- New leads are not always addressed immediately
- Manual monitoring of emails and dashboards causes delays
- Late responses reduce engagement and conversion potential

Duplicate Data Handling

- The same lead information is entered across multiple systems
- This increases repetitive work and administrative effort
- Inconsistencies arise across lead records

Human Errors

- Manual handling increases the risk of incorrect or missing data
- Errors disrupt follow-ups and lead routing
- Potential opportunities may be lost

Inconsistent Lead Qualification

- Qualification decisions depend on individual judgment
- Evaluation varies across team members
- High-quality leads may be delayed or overlooked

Lost Leads

- Manual tracking reduces visibility across the workflow
- Leads may be forgotten during handoffs
- Overall pipeline effectiveness is reduced

Follow-up Gaps

- Follow-ups rely on personal reminders
- Some leads are contacted late or not at all
- Engagement levels decrease over time

Poor Prioritization

- All leads may receive similar attention
- High-value leads are not clearly prioritized
- Sales effort is not optimally allocated

Communication Breakdowns

- Lead information is spread across multiple channels
- Status and ownership are not always clear

- Delays occur in next actions

Dependency on Individuals

- Workflow relies heavily on individual availability and experience
- Absence of key members slows the process
- Scalability and reliability are limited

7. Automation Opportunity List

Based on our detailed process mapping, actor identification, and bottleneck analysis, we have identified several tasks and steps within the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow that are highly suitable for automation. These opportunities focus on repetitive, rule-based, or time-sensitive actions where automation can significantly improve efficiency, accuracy, and consistency.

The following table summarizes the key automation opportunities which we identified in the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow, highlighting tasks that are most suitable for automation based on their repetitive, rule-based, and time-sensitive nature, along with their expected strategic and operational benefits.

Opportunity	Task / Step	Why Suitable for Automation	Type of Automation Logic	Expected Benefit
1	Manual Data Entry	Repetitive transcription of lead data is time-consuming and error-prone	Rule-based / Repetitive	Faster processing, reduced errors, improved data consistency
2	Initial Lead Screening	Duplicate checks and validation follow predictable rules	Rule-based / Trigger-based	Faster validation, elimination of invalid leads
3	Lead Categorization	Classification uses predefined criteria and scoring rules	Rule-based / Scoring logic	Consistent prioritization, better response management
4	Lead Assignment	Allocation based on workload, geography, and priority is repetitive	Rule-based / Trigger-based	Balanced workload, faster distribution, improved response times

5	Follow-up Scheduling	Follow-ups follow fixed timelines and reminders	Trigger-based / Repetitive	Timely engagement, reduced lead loss, higher conversions
6	CRM Update & Audit Logging	Manual updates are repetitive and error-prone	Repetitive / Rule-based	Accurate records, improved tracking and reporting
7	Nurturing Process Activation	Engagement sequences triggered by lead stage or behavior	Trigger-based / Repetitive	Consistent nurturing, improved lead warming, scalability

Summary:
These identified opportunities emphasize **efficiency, accuracy, and scalability**. By targeting repetitive, rule-based, and time-sensitive tasks, automation can transform the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow into a **more reliable, consistent, and scalable system**, while allowing human staff to focus on strategic interactions and high-value activities.

8. Strategic Value of Automation

Automation in the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow creates value not only at the task level but also at the **system and strategic level**, transforming how the entire process operates. Rather than simply replacing manual actions, automation restructures the workflow into a more intelligent, reliable, and scalable business system that supports long-term growth and operational excellence.

How automation improves the workflow:

- **Speed:** Eliminates manual delays in lead capture, screening, assignment, and follow-ups, enabling faster response times and quicker pipeline movement.

- **Reliability:** Reduces dependency on individual availability and memory, creating predictable and dependable process execution.

- **Scalability:** Allows the workflow to handle increasing lead volumes without proportional increases in human effort or resource constraints.

- **Accuracy:** Minimizes human errors in data handling, qualification, and tracking, ensuring cleaner and more reliable information flow.

- **Consistency:** Standardizes decisions, prioritization, and follow-up processes across the workflow, reducing variability in outcomes.

Strategic impact:

- **Business impact:** Improves conversion rates, revenue generation, and sales efficiency while strengthening long-term growth capacity.

- **Operational impact:** Enhances workflow stability, reduces bottlenecks, improves coordination, and increases overall process efficiency.

- **Customer experience impact:** Creates faster responses, clearer communication, consistent engagement, and more professional interactions, leading to higher trust and satisfaction.

At a strategic level, automation shifts the workflow from **human-dependent execution** to **system-driven performance**, enabling the organization to operate with greater intelligence, resilience, and scalability while positioning the process for future AI-driven optimization.

9. Learning Reflection

Our team worked on sales and lead generation workflow which is about mapping how sales leads are handled today, finding inefficiencies, and generating AI-driven automation system to solve them.

Our work emphasized the importance of developing automation process as the foundation of smart automation and workflow AI.

Through mapping the Sales & Lead Generation Workflow, we gained several key learning outcomes that strengthened our thinking approach about automation system.

Key reflections from this phase include:

- Recognising that effective automation system begins with clarity of process and structure.
- Improved ability to break down real-world operations into sequential steps and decision points that define system behavior.
- Deeper understanding of how human actions, system interactions, and logic-based decisions combine to shape workflow outcomes.

- Development of a deeper understanding of the approach used in identifying inefficiencies such as delays, redundancies, inconsistent qualification, and follow-up gaps.
- Increased understanding that automation is a design discipline focused on reliability, scalability, and consistency.

Overall, Week 1 assignment provide us with a strong foundation and understanding about workflow intelligence and system-level thinking which prepares us for future stages of automation design and AI-driven optimization in the upcoming weeks.

10. Conclusion

In Week-1, our team conducted a detailed analysis of the **Sales & Lead Generation Workflow** in its current, non-automated state. By mapping each step from lead generation triggers to final CRM updates and process closure, we captured all actions, actors, and decision points, providing a clear representation of how leads flow through the system in practice.

This process-first approach enabled us to view the workflow as an interconnected system rather than a collection of isolated tasks. Through this lens, we identified inefficiencies, redundancies, manual interventions, and potential bottlenecks, particularly in areas such as manual data entry, initial screening, and follow-up actions.

Documenting the workflow in this structured manner allowed us to pinpoint **high-value automation opportunities**. Steps involving repetitive, rule-based, or time-sensitive tasks such as lead categorization, assignment, follow-ups, and CRM updates are particularly suited for automation, while decision points can be enhanced with AI-supported scoring and prioritization.

Overall, the Week-1 deliverables reinforce the importance of **structured thinking and systems analysis** in automation design. The insights gained from this mapping exercise lay a strong foundation for future weeks, providing a clear analytical baseline for designing, implementing, and optimizing an automated sales and lead generation workflow. This work ensures that subsequent automation efforts will be targeted, efficient, and aligned with real-world process logic, bridging the gap between workflow understanding and intelligent automation.

End of Report
Thank You !

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Sub-Group 19 : Team Charter

Team Members	**Active Members:** Sumaiya Tasnim (sumaiyaa.tasnim.18@gmail.com) Mufutau Salami (SlamyHunta@gmail.com) Adaeze Obi (adaezeobi.va@gmail.com) Hephzibah Stephanie (10287231@upsamail.edu.gh) Nwafor Esther (esthernwafor31@gmail.com) Thanmayi Varma (tvarma1@slu.edu) Divine Ingabire Uwase (ingabireuwasedivine@gmail.com) **Inactive Member:** Shreeya Ramlugan (shreeramlugan@gmail.com) Jude Zakariya Ndak (zakariyandak@gmail.com)
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Department Head Associate	Kolawale Oparinde (kolawole@vempower.org)
Associates	Javeria Memon (javeria@vempower.org) Cheng Zhi Lai (cheng@vempower.org) Shivangi Kushwaha (shivangi@vempower.org) Shruti Mishra (shrutimishra@vempower.org)

Team Members Roles and Responsibilities	Team Members Roles and Responsibilities: Sumaiya Tasnim (sumaiyaa.tasnim.18@gmail.com) - **Team Lead**, represents team to sponsor, via email and on calls, to minimize communication errors. Hephzibah Stephanie (10287231@upsamail.edu.gh) - **Project Manager**, provides guidance and draws out insight from other team members, ensures that the project execution remains on track. Mufutau Salami (SlamyHunta@gmail.com) - **Project Scribe**, responsible to taking meeting minutes and distributing notes/assignments. Can assist Team Lead in drafting emails and communication between sponsor and group. Adaeze Obi (adaezeobi.va@gmail.com) - **Project Lead**, responsible for holding the group accountable for meeting deadlines and ensuring that the project deliverables are being met.
Mission, Vision, Objectives & Core Values	**Mission:** To design and implement intelligent automation systems that optimize workflows, enhance operational efficiency, and solve real-world challenges through AI-driven technologies. The mission focuses on applying smart automation, process intelligence, and workflow optimization to build scalable, efficient, and impactful solutions that transform how organizations operate in the digital era. **Vision:** To shape a future where AI-powered automation becomes the foundation of modern work systems. The vision is to create intelligent, adaptive, and efficient workflows that drive digital transformation, empower organizations, and develop

	a new generation of AI-ready professionals capable of leading innovation in an automated world. **Core Values***:* ● **Integrity** – We uphold transparency and accuracy in every task and report. ● **Accountability** – We take ownership of our responsibilities and deliver on time. ● **Collaboration** – We support one another through clear communication and teamwork. ● **Excellence** – We aim for continuous improvement and high-quality results. ● **Responsiveness** – We stay proactive and ensure timely communication across all channels. ● **Growth Mindset** – We view every challenge as a learning opportunity to refine our skills and strengthen our impact.
Internal Checks, Balances, and Reviews	● Team check-ins will occur daily or every 2 days unless cancelled in agreement with all team members. ● The tasks leading up to the final deliverable submission will be split between team members in an even manner. ● Team members are expected to help others with their work to ensure the completion and growth of other members. ● Daily or alternate-day check-in meetings will be used to ensure all team members or on track and ensure all doubts are getting clarified. ● Team lead and Project manager are responsible for leading meetings unless they are unable to attend and must notify so and delegate their responsibilities to someone else. ● Then, team members will work to set an agenda for the next meeting and the appropriate task deadlines.

	● Project Scribe will keep a record of group discussions, everyone's tasks, and inactive members. They will provide the documentation after the meeting in Google Chat. ● The team will have a final review of each team member's contributions to reduce errors, and they will collaboratively create the final submission for the week.
Operations: ● **Assignments** ● **Meetings** ●**Communication Guidelines** ● **Status Updates** ● **Deadlines**	**Assignments:** Tasks are distributed to members present during meetings. Absent members can be assigned tasks if they respond within 24 hours. Everyone should check the **Task Tab** regularly for updates and assigned roles. Must acknowledge assigned tasks promptly and meet deliverables. **Meetings:** Regular meetings **every Wednesdays** are required for alignment and updates. First absence is excused; consistent attendance afterward is expected. Must attend all remaining meetings and actively participate. **Communication Guidelines:** Open, respectful, and consistent communication across channels. Reply within **24 hours** and check group chats **every hour** for updates. Stay responsive and maintain professionalism in all group communications. **Status Updates:** Progress must be visible and shared for transparency. Members provide regular updates in the **chat or task tracker**. Non-reporting may affect task reassignment or accountability evaluation. **Deadlines:** All deliverables must meet agreed timelines. For members, the weekly deliverable deadline is every **Saturday at 11:00 PM IST**. Submit outputs on or before the set deadline. Late submissions require valid reasons. As all weekly submissions are on Monday in the Excelerate portal, we can verify/improve our work on Sunday by collaborating.